



The age of industry

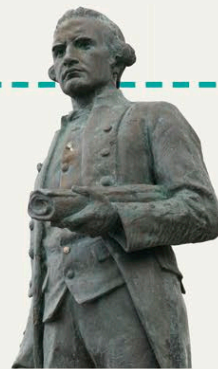
Starting around 1750, the world began to change very quickly. People rose up against their rulers, and many countries became independent for the first time. The invention of steam power led to new ways of making things and getting around. This Industrial Revolution completely changed how people lived and worked.

1756–1763

Seven Years' War
At the end of this war, the British Empire grows. It takes land from the French Empire in Canada, America, and India.

1770

James Cook
James Cook makes maps of the eastern coast of Australia, then claims Australia for Britain.



James Cook

1790

Australian revolt
Native Australian people called aborigines begin to fight back against the newly arrived British.



Aboriginal warrior

1791–1804

Haitian revolution
Slave workers on plantations in Haiti revolt, led by Toussaint Louverture. Haiti becomes the first black-ruled state in the Americas.

1800–1815

Napoleonic Wars
The French ruler, Napoleon, tries to conquer other countries in Europe and fights wars against other European nations.



1856

Steel

Henry Bessemer invents a process to create steel that is strong enough to make railroads, skyscrapers, and machines.



Karl Marx

1848

Communist Manifesto

Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels write and publish *The Communist Manifesto*, describing their radical new ideas about how money should be divided between people.

1839–1842

First Opium War

Britain starts a war against China to force China to trade. In 1842, Britain wins the war and takes Hong Kong.

1857–1858

Indian Mutiny

India tries to become independent from British rule but does not succeed.

1861–1865

American Civil War

In the United States, North and South go to war over slavery. The North wins and slavery is abolished.

1867

Canadian independence

Canada becomes an independent country and is no longer ruled by Great Britain.



Emperor Meiji

1868

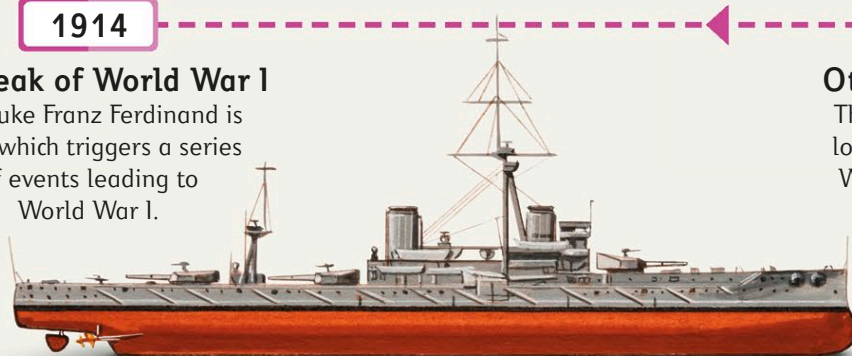
Meiji Restoration

Emperor Meiji takes control of Japan and modernizes how the country is ruled.

1914

Outbreak of World War I

Archduke Franz Ferdinand is shot, which triggers a series of events leading to World War I.



Warship

1913

Ottoman retreat

The Ottoman Empire loses the First Balkan War, and most of its lands in Europe.

1912

Chinese Revolution

Sun Yat-sen leads a revolution in China, overthrowing the Manchu dynasty, which had ruled for 276 years.